KALE REALTY

TWO-THIRDS OF ZILLOW LEADS GO TO ONE PROGRAM.

If you're not in it, your lead flow is shrinking on purpose.

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ZILLOW'S PREFERRED AGENT PROGRAM TOOK TWO-THIRDS OF ALL BUYER CONNECTIONS LAST QUARTER, ROUGHLY DOUBLE WHAT IT TOOK A YEAR EARLIER.

Zillow says it's aiming for 100% of buyer connections by mid-2027.

THIS ISN'T YOUR MARKETING UNDERPERFORMING.

Per HousingWire's report on Zillow's Q3 2026 earnings, Preferred connections generate **35% more revenue per connection** than Zillow's old lead model. That's the actual reason the funnel is narrowing. It's not that non-Preferred agents suddenly got worse at converting leads, it's that Zillow makes more money routing buyers to the agents already inside the program, and it is building toward sending every buyer connection that way.

WHAT TO CHECK BEFORE NEXT QUARTER:

1 **Pull your actual Zillow numbers for the last two quarters.**
Side by side, not from memory. Know the real trend before you react to it.

2 **Calculate your Zillow-to-total-pipeline ratio.**
What percentage of your business depends on a company whose own earnings call says it wants to control 100% of that connection?

3 **Build one lead source Zillow's algorithm can't touch.**
Your own CRM, a past-client cadence, your local sphere. Something that still works if the number above hits zero.

THE TAKEAWAY

HERE'S WHAT YOU DO NOW.

Write down your real Zillow-to-total-leads ratio before next quarter. If that number scares you, that's the number to fix, not your marketing.

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